Sony 1000X The Collexion

A familiar friend, now luxurious

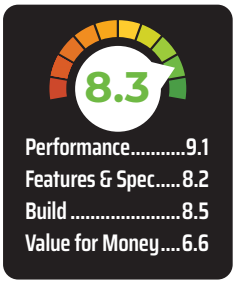
₹59,990

Sony released The Collexion headphones to mark the 10th anniversary of its flagship 1000X headphones series. While the 1000X series is known for top-notch noise cancellation and sound quality, this milestone edition brings a more luxurious design. The first thing I noticed about the 1000X The Collexion is that it has a more premium finish than the Sony WH-1000XM6, along with a premium price of Rs 59,990. To put this into perspective, the 1000XM6 is priced at Rs 39,990. The obvious question is how good a product the newcomer is and whether the quality upgrade warrants the higher price tag.



PREMIUM DESIGN

As I said, the headphones' colour, material, and finish were what I first noticed. The Sony 1000X Collexion features metal hinges, and the rest of the body is mostly made of recycled plastic and faux leather. It looks rich and sophisticated. Because of the inclusion of more metal in the build, The Collexion weighs 320g and is considerably heavier than the 254g WH-1000XM6. The weight isn't something that would bother you while wearing it. For context, it is lighter and more comfortable than the Apple AirPods Max 2.



The headphone's plush and fairly flexible headband and earcups not just add to comfort but also offer solid passive isolation. That said, the leather cushions could get warm with longer use in a non-AC rooms or outdoors. This isn't a build problem, but rather something to know in Indian conditions. Speaking of conditions, the Collexion lacks an IP rating. So no dust or water resistance. But the case covers the entire device and offers some protection. It also has a handle to carry around. The overall footprint of the case is larger than the WH-1000XM4 I have. This is because the new headphones' hinge is not foldable like an XM4 or XM6.

In everyday use, whether you are indoors or out, you would appreciate the simplicity, accessibility, and tactility of the physical buttons on this thing.

ENERGETIC SOUND

Sony has given The Collexion a new 30mm driver with a carbon-composite construction and worked with mastering engineers for its tuning.

In our testing, the frequency response curve shows a weighty low end with a strong sense of sub-bass depth. Kick drums have plenty of body, and the drum beats at the beginning of 'Hold On' by Alabama Shakes sound more pronounced than on the AirPods Max 2.

In 'Slow Sipper' by The Dips, the positioning of the instruments and vocals is clear. While listening to 'Laiyaan', the texture of Arijit Singh's voice was easier to pick out, with a smoother presentation on the Sony headphones.

'Long Road' by Eddie Vedder was another interesting listen. Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan's vocals sounded stronger and clearer, with more presence than on the other headphones I compared them with. More importantly, the bass does not overpower vocals or instruments. Vocals sound natural and relaxed, while instruments have enough space around them.

Highs are also well controlled. Cymbals, strings, and other finer details have enough energy to remain audible, but they do not sound sharp or piercing. This gives the Collexion a slightly relaxed treble character that is suited for long listening sessions.

The company has also added 360 Upmix, which converts conventional stereo content into a spatial presentation. There are separate Music, Cinema and Game modes to experiment with. I found the feature more useful for certain types of content than others, and more processing does not necessarily mean better sound.

There is also wired audio support through the bundled 3.5mm cable. However, the headphones must be switched on for wired playback to work. I miss the genuine passive mode available on my XM4, which means I can continue listening through the cable even when the headphones are switched off.

The USB-C port is limited to charging and does not support USB-C audio. So, you cannot connect The Collexion to a laptop or phone over